

Best Bank in Human Capital Excellence:

Banks were evaluated on interventions across four critical focus areas under: Technology as an enabler to drive employee experience throughout the employee lifecycle; Innovation in talent acquisition; Innovation in talent management; Initiatives around diversity, equity, inclusion and governance. Each of these areas were further evaluated based on uniqueness of idea, breadth of the initiative, implementation evidence, and impact achieved.

Best Bank in Emerging Tech and AI:

We evaluated the banks on the maturity of their AI and emerging tech capability on six dimensions. These were strategy and vision, technology and innovation, impact, partnerships, adoption and scale, and governance. Each dimension had clearly defined criteria and weights that reflected their relative importance.

The assessment granularity looked at clarity of strategic intent, depth and scalability of technology deployment, execution capability, demonstrable and measurable impact, strength of partnerships and external recognition, breadth of enterprise-wide adoption, and robustness of governance and responsible AI practices.

Best Bank in Social Impact:

Banks were evaluated and ranked on a composite scoring framework across three core social impact pillars of financial inclusion, community focus, and livelihood enablement. Category-wise and parameter-level weightages were assigned.

Key indicators assessed include access to formal banking, priority sector lending performance, credit deployment to underserved segments (women entrepreneurs,

self-help groups, marginal farmers and vulnerable communities), scale and reach of CSR beneficiaries, convergence of government schemes, rural and last-mile coverage, and initiatives across healthcare, education, livelihoods, and environmental sustainability. Banks were assessed based on quantitative metrics, qualitative disclosures, their responses to questions, and independent research-based parameters to capture both the scale and depth of social impact.

model, service delivery and digital adoption—evaluated based on self-nomination responses to the survey floated by KPMG. Like the Best Bank innovation award, the entries received were evaluated and ranked based on four key parameters including area of impact, uniqueness of the solution, adoption of the solution and impact created by the initiative.

Human Capital Excellence:

All participating NBFCs were evaluated on interventions across

Banks were evaluated and ranked on a scoring framework across 3 core social impact pillars

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Business Transformation Leader of the Year

In addition to the institutional awards, the Survey also recognises CEOs who have undertaken bank-wide transformation and brought about significant growth to a bank. The process involved assessment of the transformation journey of CEOs across multiple parameters such as leadership; vision, impact of the transformation and institutionalisation, scalability and sustainability of the transformation.

QUALITATIVE NBFC AWARDS

(Large NBFCs with assets greater than or equal to ₹10,000 crore)

Best Innovation: Promising initiatives across five focus areas—customer experience, product innovation, business

four focus areas: Technology as an enabler to drive employee experience; Innovation in talent acquisition; Innovation in talent management; Initiatives around diversity, equity, inclusion, and governance. These were further evaluated on uniqueness of idea, breadth of initiative, implementation evidence, and impact.

QUALITATIVE AWARDS

(Best in Fintech Value Added Service) The methodology applied a structured, weighted scoring framework to assess organisational maturity of the firms and their sustainability and impact. This was executed by using four assessment lenses; company health, differentiation, scalability, and regulatory compliance. **BT**